EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



KOLOBOK: THE ROLLING BUN

A Classic Woodland Fable on Vigilance, Humility, and Seeing Through Flattery

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group"

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Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *KOLOBOK: THE ROLLING BUN* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Parallels 'The Gingerbread Man' and 'The Johnny-Cake' alongside Sun Tzu's classic warnings against arrogance after early victories.

> **Proverb of the Book:** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. FRESH FROM THE OVEN AND IMPATIENT ON THE WINDOWSILL ❧



Once upon a time an old Grandfather and Grandmother baked a round, golden, fragrant bun—Kolobok—brushed with melted butter and placed him on the cottage windowsill to cool.

Growing impatient with the quiet yard, Kolobok rolled from the sill to the bench, from the bench to the grass, and out through the garden gate onto the winding forest road without telling his family.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

❧ SHEET II. OUTRUNNING THE HARE AND THE WOLF ❧



Along the path he met the Little Hare and then the Grey Wolf, each ready to gobble him up. Yet Kolobok sang his cheerful boasting song and rolled briskly past their paws before they could blink.

With every easy escape his chest swelled with pride: he began to believe that no danger in the world could ever touch him.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

❧ SHEET III. OUTRUNNING THE BEAR AND THE PEAK OF OVERCONFIDENCE ❧



When even the clumsy Brown Bear failed to catch him among the pines, Kolobok's confidence turned into dizziness: 'I left Grandfather, I left Grandmother, and I outsmarted every beast in the woods!'

He no longer watched the road ahead, sure that his own clever song made him invincible.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

❧ SHEET IV. THE FOX WHO DID NOT THREATEN—SHE PRAISED! ❧



Then out stepped the sleek Red Fox. Unlike the Wolf and the Bear, she did not growl or bare her teeth. Instead, she smiled sweetly: 'Oh, Kolobok, what a rosy, golden crust you have, and what a marvellous voice! Only I have grown a little hard of hearing—hop onto my nose and sing your song one more time!'

Enchanted by the sweet flattery, Kolobok forgot every caution and leaped straight onto the Fox's nose.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

❧ SHEET V. THE BAKER'S LESSON: STAY CONNECTED TO YOUR SAFE BASE ❧



In the old tale, that single leap onto the flatterer's nose ends Kolobok's journey. In our family wisdom lesson, we pause right at that threshold to learn the shield that saves every traveller: never roll away without telling your family, never let past victories blind your eyes, and remember that whenever someone praises you too sweetly while asking you to step closer to danger—step back to safe ground immediately!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"A fierce growl puts you on guard, but sweet flattery puts vigilance to sleep."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. How was the Fox's trick different from the Wolf and the Bear?**
  The Wolf and Bear growled openly, while the Fox used sweet compliments. Why is flattery harder to spot than anger?
- **2. Why did Kolobok believe the Fox so easily?**
  How did winning three times in a row make him stop paying attention to safety rules?
- **3. What is the 'Fox's Nose' rule for kids today?**
  If a stranger on the street or online praises you and asks you to come closer or keep a secret from parents, what do you do in one second?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *Someone you barely know—in the park or in an online game—praises how smart and grown-up you are and asks you to step away from your parents or share your home address.*

Path 1 (Kolobok on the Fox's Nose): Feel proud of the compliment and do what they ask without checking.

Path 2 (Rolling Away Alone Without Telling Parents): Wander off into unfamiliar places thinking 'I already know everything!'

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (Clear Eyes & Safe Home Base!): Recognize the 'Fox's compliment' right away, step back, and tell your parents immediately!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw Kolobok choosing the safe road back to Grandfather and Grandmother's cottage with a bright lantern of wisdom!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Practice the 'Pause Before Praise' game: when someone flatters you to get a favour, smile and take three calm breaths before answering.

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: CONNECTION TO FAMILY & SAFETY RULES → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: SOBER SELF-AWARENESS & VIGILANCE

Lesson II • Warm Child Easily Flattered
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Loves the family, yet forgets caution the moment a peer or stranger offers sweet praise.

★ CONFIDENT & SAFE EXPLORER
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
Joyful talent and independence grounded in strong family ties and immunity to manipulation.

Lesson I • Rolling Onto the Fox's Nose
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Running away from home rules and falling for the first sweet-talking manipulator.

Lesson III • Fearful Sitting Behind Shutters
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Safe indoors, yet afraid to learn, sing, or make real friends.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Never leave the windowsill without agreement: Always let your parents know where you are going and with whom.

2. Compliments + Secrecy = Step Back!: True friends never ask you to hide things from your family or step onto a 'Fox's nose.'

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. Kolobok — Star Founder or Division Infected by Hubris:** After beating three slow legacy competitors (Hare, Wolf, Bear), believes rules, audits, and board oversight no longer apply.
- **2. Grandfather & Grandmother — Founding Governance & Core Perimeter:** The institutional memory, risk controls, and capital base that the star performer dismisses as 'old-fashioned.'
- **3. Hare, Wolf & Bear — Predictable Direct Competitors:** Openly aggressive rivals whose straightforward attacks are easy to dodge with speed.
- **4. The Red Fox — Sophisticated Predator Using Flattery & Leverage:** Counterparty, distressed-debt fund, or social-engineering attacker who praises your genius while structuring a lethal trap.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

> **Trap 1 — The Hubris Syndrome After Three Consecutive Wins:** Relaxing due diligence, legal review, and security protocols right after a record quarter.

> **Trap 2 — Falling for 'Fox Counterparties' Who Praise Instead of Negotiating:** When a vendor, investor, or buyer agrees to all your vanity wishes while slipping in a change-of-control or exclusivity trap.

> **★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Institutional humility, Four-Eyes Due Diligence & Perimeter Lock:** The sweeter the counterparty's praise, the stricter your independent legal and financial verification.

AXIS Y ↑: GOVERNANCE & RISK-PERIMETER DISCIPLINE → | AXIS X ►: SOBER REALITY CHECK & DUE DILIGENCE (HUBRIS & SUSCEPTIBILITY TO FLATTERY → INDEPENDENT VERIFICATION ('FOUR EYES'))

Quadrant 2 • Compliant But Naive to Charm
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Follows internal rules, yet gets charmed by smooth-talking external counterparties.

★ AGILE LEADER WITH AN IRON SHIELD
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
High market speed and boldness backed by zero-vanity due diligence and strong governance.

Quadrant 1 • Solo Flight Into the Fox's Jaws
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Breaking away from governance in euphoria and signing a fatal deal under flattery.

Quadrant 3 • Frozen on the Windowsill
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
All controls and zero market motion—never leaving the kitchen.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Watch out—the Fox is praising our song!"	A counterparty is flattering us excessively instead of bargaining on substance.	**★ Trigger an independent legal and background audit of the deal terms.**
"Beating the Bear doesn't make us Fox-proof"	Outrunning slow legacy rivals does not mean we can ignore sophisticated financial or cyber risks.	**★ Upgrade security and contract controls as revenue scales.**
"Don't roll off the windowsill without the board"	A star unit is launching an unapproved side deal outside group risk limits.	**★ Enforce the Four-Eyes approval gate.**
"Step back from the nose"	We are being asked to waive a critical protection ('just sign today without escrow').	**★ Refuse the waiver and require full collateral.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
Independent Third-Party Audit Clauses; Anti-Flattery Governance; Multi-Signature Treasury Controls.

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